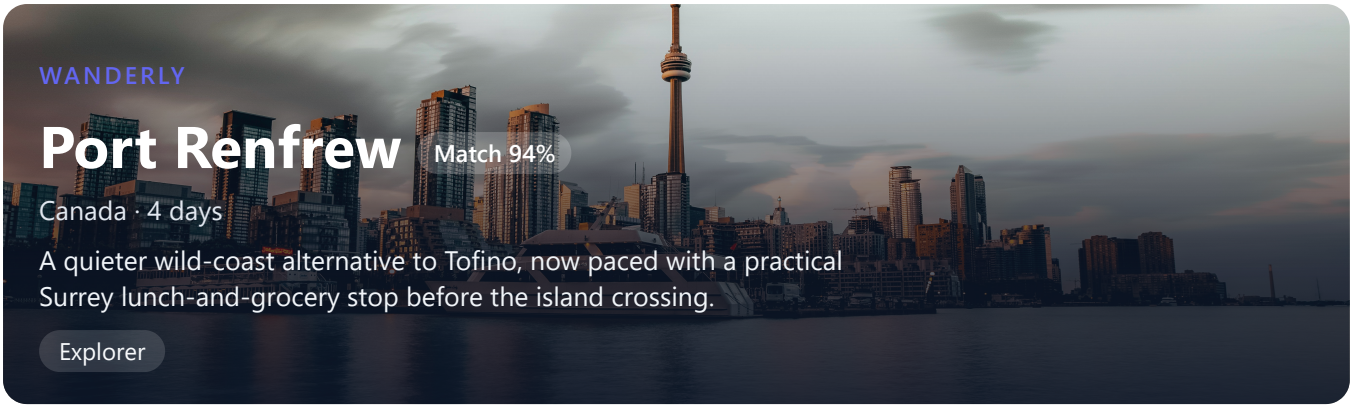


WANDERLY

Port Renfrew

Match 94%

Canada · 4 days

A quieter wild-coast alternative to Tofino, now paced with a practical Surrey lunch-and-grocery stop before the island crossing.

Explorer

🗓️ When **May 21–24 (Memorial Day weekend) · return May 24**

👥 Who **Travelers + dog**

✈️ Flying from **Seattle, WA (road trip start)**

✨ Vibe **Quiet rugged coast, little-touristy, scenic outdoor time**

💰 Budget **Not specified**

⏱️ Duration **4 days · 3 nights**

BUDGET

Trip estimate	≈ $550–950 pp · 4d road
Lodging	cabin/motel ~$120–220/n
Flights	N/A — drive + ferry only

Notes

Holiday weekend ferry reservations and limited Port Renfrew inventory tighten costs; Surrey stock-up reduces pricey island dining but adds a modest grocery line. Dog fees and ferry surcharges can add $80–150 trip-wide.

GETTING THERE

GROUND_ONLY

Seattle road trip: cross into BC, practical Surrey lunch-and-grocery stop before Tsawwassen–Nanaimo ferry, then Hwy 14 to Port Renfrew for three nights. May 24 return reverses ferry and highway with an optional Surrey buffer before Seattle — no commercial air.

Where you stay

- **Port Renfrew** (1-3) — One wild-coast base; Surrey is a transit provisioning stop only, not an overnight

DAY BY DAY

1 Seattle → Surrey → island → coast

Base: Port Renfrew · mixed · Drive + Surrey stop + BC Ferries positioning

🚗 Seattle → Surrey · 🚶 Surrey · 🚗 Surrey → Tsawwassen · ⛴️ Tsawwassen → Nanaimo · 🚗 Nanaimo → Port Renfrew

🏨 Port Renfrew · in 2026-05-21 · out 2026-05-22

- Early depart Seattle; I-5 north with NEXUS or standard border timing in mind
- Surrey stop: lunch and grocery run (Costco, T&T, or local strip) before the ferry rush
- BC Ferries Tsawwassen → Nanaimo; reserve Memorial Day sailing with pet-friendly vehicle terms
- Island drive Duncan → Lake Cowichan → Hwy 14 west into Port Renfrew
- Check in; short leash walk at harbour or Pacheedaht Beach — dinner from groceries

2 Old-growth giants → Avatar Grove

Base: Port Renfrew

🚗 Port Renfrew → Avatar Grove area · 🚶 Avatar Grove trailhead → Avatar Grove area · 🚗 Avatar Grove area → Port Renfrew

🏨 Port Renfrew · in 2026-05-22 · out 2026-05-23

- Village coffee; pack layers, water, and day snacks from Surrey haul
- Drive toward Avatar Grove / Big Lonely Doug near Lake Cowichan (watch for rough gravel)
- Forest loops among ancient cedar and Douglas fir; dog leashed in sensitive stands
- Optional Harris Creek Spruce or viewpoint pullouts on the return leg
- Easy evening: Sombrio or Jones Beach sunset if weather cooperates

3 Botanical Beach tide pools → Avatar Grove

Base: Port Renfrew

🚗 Port Renfrew → Botanical Beach Provincial Park · 🚶 Botanical Beach trailhead → Botanical Beach Provincial Park · 🚗 Botanical Beach Provincial Park → Port Renfrew

🏨 Port Renfrew · in 2026-05-23 · out 2026-05-24

- Check tide tables — plan low tide at Botanical Beach Provincial Park
- Sandstone shelves, surge channels, and pools (avoid slick black rock when waves run)
- Picnic from stocked groceries; respect leash rules and any closed wildlife zones
- Afternoon: China Beach or Parkinson Creek for a second coastal mood
- Pack road snacks for tomorrow's ferry-and-border day

4 Coast out → Avatar Grove

Base: Port Renfrew · mixed · Island drive + ferry; optional Surrey on homeward leg

🚗 Port Renfrew → Nanaimo · ⛴ Nanaimo → Tsawwassen · 🚗 Tsawwassen → Surrey · 🚗 Surrey → Seattle

- Breakfast and pack-out; final leash walk on the beach
- Hwy 14 east to Nanaimo ferry — Memorial Day sailing buffer
- BC Ferries to Tsawwassen; optional quick Surrey pit stop for fuel or snacks
- Border re-entry and I-5 south to Seattle for May 24 return
